

Street Sign Work Orders

Operational performance overview - dashboard documentation

Prepared by Sowmiya Kumar | Data source: City of Austin Open Data Portal (data.austintexas.gov) | Period covered: 2019 - 14 July 2026

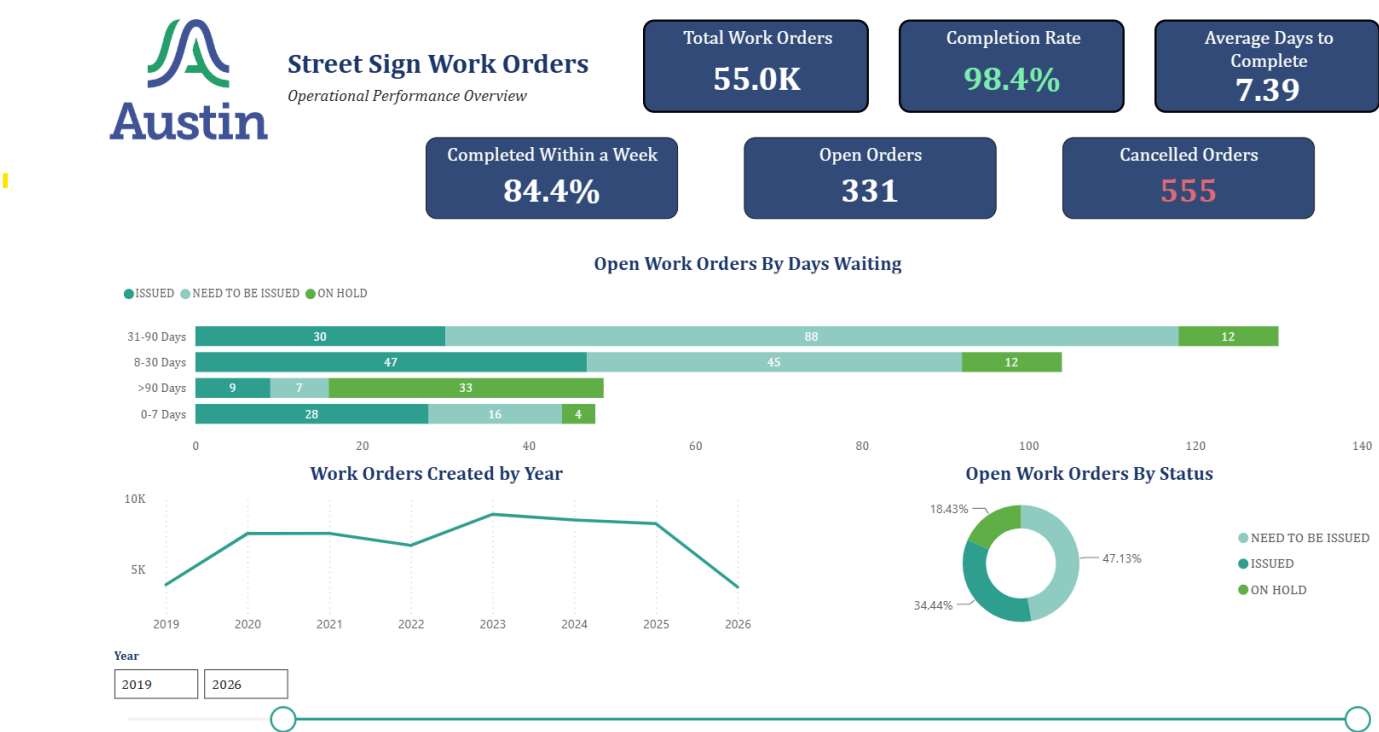
Purpose

This dashboard is a self-directed analysis of the City of Austin's Street Sign Work Orders dataset, built to explore how work order performance can be tracked and where delays tend to occur. It covers work managed by the Signs & Markings division for the installation and maintenance of street signs across the City of Austin's full-purpose jurisdiction.

Key findings

- Overall performance is strong. Of all work orders raised since 2019, 98.4% have reached completion, with an average turnaround of 7.39 days and 84.4% completed within a week.
- The current backlog is small. Only 331 work orders remain open - under 1% of total volume - against 55,000 total work orders raised in the period.
- Delays are concentrated in one status, not spread evenly. Work orders placed On Hold make up only 18% of the open backlog, but account for 67% of all work orders that have been open longer than 90 days. By contrast, work orders in Issued or Need to Be Issued status rarely remain open that long.
- Most of the remaining backlog is moving, just slowly. Work orders in Need to Be Issued status make up the largest share of the 31–90 day range, suggesting a scheduling or assignment step that most orders eventually clear, rather than a stalling point.
- Yearly volume has been stable since 2020, generally between 7,000 and 9,000 work orders created per year. The apparent drop in 2026 reflects a partial year of data (through 14 July 2026), not an actual decline in activity.

Dashboard



How the metrics are defined

- Completion rate - the share of all work orders that have reached a Closed or Final Review status, out of every work order ever raised in the selected period. Cancelled work orders are included in this total.
- Average days to complete - the average number of calendar days between a work order being created and being marked complete, calculated only for work orders that have actually finished.
- Completed within a week - the share of completed work orders that finished within 7 calendar days of being raised.
- Open orders - work orders that are not yet Closed, in Final Review, or Cancelled. This is the current active backlog.
- Cancelled orders - work orders that were withdrawn before completion. These are tracked separately and excluded from the open backlog and duration figures, since they were never going to complete.
- Days waiting / age buckets - for open work orders only, the number of days since creation, grouped into four ranges (0-7, 8-30, 31-90, and over 90 days) to show how long work has been sitting at each status.

Notes and limitations

- 2026 figures reflect data through 14 July 2026 only and should not be read as a full-year total.
- 2018 is excluded from this view, as the dataset begins partway through that year (May 2018) and was treated the same way as the current partial year to keep year-over-year comparisons consistent.
- This analysis was built independently, outside of any work assignment, using a public dataset from the City of Austin's Open Data Portal, as a way of practising the reporting approach discussed at interview.

Suggested next steps

- Investigate the specific reasons work orders are placed On Hold, to understand whether the long aging in this status reflects a resourcing constraint, a dependency on a third party, or a process gap.
- Consider setting a target turnaround time for On Hold work orders specifically, given they behave differently from every other open status.
- Extend this analysis using the related Signs & Markings Time Logs dataset, which can be joined on work order ID, to see whether logged work hours help explain the On Hold pattern.